EXAMPLE 5.23

Four round objects namely a ring, a disc, a hollow sphere and a solid sphere with same radius R start to roll down an incline at the same time. Find out which object will reach the bottom first.

Solution

For all the four objects namely the ring, disc, hollow sphere and solid sphere, the radii of gyration K are R, $\sqrt{\frac{1}{2}}$R, $\sqrt{\frac{2}{3}}$R, $\sqrt{\frac{2}{5}}$R (ref Table (5.3)). With numerical values the radius of gyration K are 1R, 0.707R, 0.816R, 0.632R respectively. The expression for time taken for rolling has the radius of gyration K in the numerator as per equation 5.63

$$t = \sqrt{\frac{2h\left(1+\frac{K^2}{R^2}\right)}{g\sin^2\theta}}$$

The one with least value of radius of gyration K will take the shortest time to reach the bottom of the inclined plane. The order of objects reaching the bottom is first, solid sphere; second, disc; third, hollow sphere and last, ring.

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SUMMARY

- A rigid body is the one in which the distances between different particles remain constant.
- For regular shaped bodies with uniform mass distribution, centre of mass always lies at the geometrical centre.
- Net torque produces turning motion in rigid object.
- A rigid body is in translational equilibrium if the total external force on it is zero. It is in rotational equilibrium if the total external torque on it is zero.
- The centre of gravity of an extended body is that point where the total gravitational torque on the body is zero.
- If the external torque acting on the body is zero, the component of angular momentum along the axis of rotation is constant.
- There are rotational equivalents for all the translational quantities.
- Rolling motion is the combination of translational and rotational motions.
- Rolling can also be treated as the momentary rotation about the point of contact.
- In pure rolling, the total kinetic energy is the sum of kinetic energies of translational and rotational motions.
- In sliding the translational motion is more than rotational motion.
- In slipping the rotational motion is more than translational motion.

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